The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 9:30 pm CDT on Tuesday 20 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Friday 23 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A trough of low pressure lingers about the east, before weakening from late Wednesday. A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea will re-establish a ridge across southern parts from Wednesday. A trough is then forecast to briefly move into the west on Thursday, before another trough and cold front move more broadly across SA on Friday and Saturday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore early in the morning. Winds tending east to northeasterly before dawn then tending east to southeasterly in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly in the early morning then shifting south to southeasterly in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny morning. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending easterly in the early morning then turning south to southeasterly in the late morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

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Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: East to southeasterly below 10 knots tending southerly 15 to 20 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny day. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southeasterly in the middle of the day then tending east to southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots in the early morning then becoming variable in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southerly 10 to 15 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots in the early morning then becoming variable in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres in the west. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

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Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 to 4 metres, decreasing to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then tending southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots tending south to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then tending south to southeasterly in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming northwest to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then tending southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly below 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots tending east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres later in the evening. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northwesterly during the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Northwest to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending west to northwesterly during the morning then turning south to southwesterly below 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 70% chance of showers.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres north of Cowell to Wallaroo. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the late evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Weather: Mostly sunny.

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Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 2 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon and evening.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: North to northeasterly below 10 knots tending southerly 10 to 15 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Mostly clear.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres, decreasing to 1 to 1.5 metres around midday, then increasing to 1 to 2 metres later in the evening. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots during the day then turning southerly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. 50% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the evening.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:40 am CDT Wednesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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